

## airshow

It was a fantastic event in August on the Gold Coast and over 200,000 visitors attended the 2026 Pacific Air Show in Queensland. Travel Radio Australia was there. I wanted to get it started.

I know you're the same program. You're going to hear a lot of pictures that carry history. You're going to watch modern masters of flight.

We're going to keep looking up and welcome, ladies and gentlemen, with the 2026 Pacific Air Show at the Gold Coast because it starts right now. Look at this thing. It's in the back end here.

This is the Star Master. I'm here and here it goes. High, high, high above the Red Berets.

Is that an incredible Gold Coast? Come on, let's hear it for Team Gravity. There you go. Isn't that awesome? Now, we're going to see the wrap.

The most lethal fighter in the air. Where is he? There he is. There he is.

He's doing a massive step. He's going to take a look at his turn. You just see him.

He's going to come up. There you go. Listen to that.

The smoke out front that's not an airplane. That is a man. A man in a wingsuit.

The Red and the Black is Shinto and the Black is Red, and the Red is Blue. Team Liberty, they come back to go head to head. It is, well, not a bird, not a plane.

It is, I'd ever be 20 to the Osprey. Whoa, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey, hey. Oh, the first in Australian race team is incredible.

Come on, Gold Coast. Airplanes aren't supposed to bother. Travel Radio Australia, and we're here at the fantastic Pacific Air Show, when we have, as our special guest, Micka Gray from the Royal Australian Air Force.

He's one of the pilots here, and he's chief from the Royal Australian Air Force of air shows in Australia. Micka, welcome to the program. Yeah, thanks very much.

Yeah, it was a great event here at the Gold Coast Pacific Air Show. Really good. Yeah, now tell us your experience of this and tell us about some of the preparations that go into this.

It's pretty, pretty full on, right? Yeah, so I have the privilege of leading our Air Force Air Show team, which does all the planning for our Air Force shows at the Air Force places. Here, Air Force and the Army participate in the Pacific Air Show Gold Coast. It's a magnificent array of some of the best civilian performers.

And of course, it gives us the opportunity to showcase some of our incredible military assets. Yeah, tell us about the aircraft that you fly here in particular. Yeah, so my flying days are done.

On the day I used to fly F-111s and Super Hornets and tornadoes with the RAF years ago. But what we've been contributing here is our warbirds, the Mustang and Spitfire, the Roulettes, our aerobatic display team. Been a crowd favorite for many years and just a beautiful display.

We've had the C-130 Hercules and of course the F-35 Lightning too, the most modern fighter aircraft in the world. And tell us about your role outside this particular show. You go all around Australia doing this, right? So we do one major Air Force show every two years.

And then on the alternate years, a show and an open day at Darwin as part of exercise pitch flight. So most of these events are quite complex, about a year of planning and then the running of it for a couple of days. Yeah, it's a great role.

We're all ex-Air Force, we're still in the Air Force, but as reservists, covering all the aspects of event management. And what is your favorite aircraft here? What are some of your particular ones you like? Yeah, I think the Yak-110 and people don't know, it's the two Yak-55s that Jeff decided and a couple of mates, so let's see if we can join two aircraft together and make it airworthy. And they did.

It's an incredible feat of not just aviation, but just engineering. And that's what these air shows are all about. Everyone just looks at the pilots and the air crew, but it's all that stuff that goes into making aviation and science, technology, engineering, maths work.

And it's been a magnificent event. We've been very lucky with the weather. It's been magnificent, especially on the last day, the first two days were great too, but the last days have been absolutely perfect for flying.

Oh, exactly. You know, you looked at the forecast, it was supposed to be showers rolling through, that hasn't really happened. The cloud is actually a great backdrop.

You know, you get better visuals, great for photography. I've seen a lot of people with long lenses out there. It's great.

And that stuff is, you know, all over the internet. There's some really good contributions out there. And tell us just an overview of what shows are on per year.

You said earlier, what's your next big one coming up? We're looking at doing a show in the West, Western Australia next year. More details to come on that one. Great, Mickah Gray.

Thank you from the Royal Australian Air Force. Thank you very much for being part of the program. Thanks very much.